Superkeys & Keys

Superkeys & keys

Intuition: R's attributes should be dependent on exactly R's primary key.

A set A of attributes is a superkey of relation R iff $A \rightarrow R$.

Equivalently, iff $A^+ = R$.

A (candidate) key is a minimal superkey.

We pick a key as primary key.

Activity: Find superkeys & keys

Product(name, price, category, color)

{name, category} → {price}

{category} → {color}